# James Praise

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product marketer who has built the function from scratch at early-stage SaaS companies since 2021, and in marketing since 2018. I set positioning and naming, build the competitive pages and battlecards sales use, run launches, and turn customer research into messaging. I have repositioned a product into a new category story, built competitor pages that brought more ready-to-buy leads, and done product marketing for vertical software sold to operators. I also build customer acquisition offers for US local-service businesses, including HVAC and home care. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/lace-ai.

**Selected Achievements:**

- Repositioned Reform from a general form builder around lead conversion: **34% lift in trial activation**. Built competitor pages against Typeform and Jotform: **19% more decision-stage leads**.
- Lifted sales qualified leads **50%** and sales conversion **25%** at Bento Africa, a payroll and HR software company, through lead scoring and segment-based nurture.
- Built the feature launch framework at Reform that lifted new feature adoption **26% within 90 days**, and launched the Pro Plan free trial: **21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion**.
- Generated **1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months** as Head of Growth and Marketing at Bujeti (YC W23), and grew new B2B customers **500% in Q1 2024**.
- Rose from Sales Manager to **Chief Revenue Officer** at Cecure Intelligence Limited, running sales and marketing as one team: **1,646 marketing qualified leads, 629 demos and $3.4M in open deal value**.

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## KEY SKILLS

**Strategy:** Positioning & Messaging, Category & Product Naming, Competitive Intelligence & Battlecards, ICP & Persona Research, Go-to-Market & Launch Planning, Pricing & Packaging Narrative

**Execution:** Product Launches, Sales Enablement (decks, one-pagers, battlecards), Competitor & Comparison Pages, Customer Interviews & Case Studies, Lifecycle & Nurture, Partner Programs, Local-Service Acquisition Offers

**Tools:** HubSpot, GA4, Looker Studio, Google Tag Manager, Mixpanel, Webflow, Brevo, PartnerStack, Meta & Google Ads, Claude Code, n8n

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# PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present**
*Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)*

- Built MIA Acquisition, a pay-per-qualified-lead acquisition service for US local-service businesses, and launched offers for home care, HVAC, pressure washing, water treatment, medspa and garage-floor epoxy owners.
- Built a paid-acquisition system that judges campaigns on backend sales instead of ad-platform reports. It caught Meta cross-crediting sales between products.
- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate, writing product showcases for software companies.

**Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026**
*Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)*

- Repositioned the product around lead conversion and rebuilt the landing pages: 34% lift in trial activation.
- Built competitor pages (Typeform, Jotform) and integration pages: 19% more decision-stage leads and 28% more organic sessions from integration pages.
- Built the feature launch framework, with a priority matrix and channel map: 26% lift in new feature adoption within 90 days.
- Launched the Pro Plan free trial across web, email and in-app: 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion.
- Ran the freemium sunset that moved 72% of legacy free users onto paid plans, and built the affiliate program on PartnerStack.

**GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026**
*FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)*

- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.
- Led the FunnelEnvy rebrand, including the sales deck system.

**Head of Inbound Marketing & SEO | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024**
*Distrobird (sales engagement SaaS, US)*

- Led a content team of five writers and two editors and ranked for 3,000+ competitive keywords in three months.

**Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024**
*Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)*

- Built the growth function from scratch across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.

- Redesigned lifecycle email and in-app flows: 20% higher engagement and 10% lower churn.

**Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023**
*Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)*

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer, running revenue operations and cross-functional GTM teams.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads, 406 sales qualified leads and 629 demos: $3.4M in open deal value.

**Product Marketing & Growth Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022**
*B2B, SaaS, fintech and consumer brands*

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across four countries): 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion from lead scoring and lifecycle nurture.
- Marketing & Growth Advisor at JegzFits Leatherworks (consumer brand, Nigeria, 2021 to present): Meta and TikTok acquisition at about 8x return on ad spend over five years.

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# EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0